



HU XIAOFEI/VCG/GETTY IMAGES

Workers assemble electric vehicles at a Leapmotor factory in Jinhua, China, on Jan. 3. The start-up sold 280,000 EVs last year.

In EV race, China caught up with West — then charged ahead

BY CHRISTIAN SHEPHERD

JINHUA, CHINA — In the manufacturing heartlands of eastern China, Jinhua New Energy Vehicle Town stands as a monument to the country's decade-long march to dominance in electric cars.

Launched in 2015, the “town” is an industrial zone with ambition: Its fancy apartments and parks dedicated to “automotive culture” abut giant factories, so that workers might live and lead the electric vehicle revolution that would upend global car markets.

Today, Jinhua's EV dreamscape is becoming a reality. The city is one of at least a dozen localities vying to be-

U.S., E.U. efforts to level field can't match Beijing's planning, local investment

come China's Detroit for the electric age.

China now produces more than 60 percent of the world's electric cars and 80 percent of the batteries that power them. Its automotive champions, once desperate for foreign cooperation, are these days sought out for their innovation.

“Now they are at the forefront of the technology,” said John Helveston, an

expert on Chinese EVs in George Washington University's engineering department, noting that Chinese companies spent a decade focused on cutting costs with automation and streamlined supply chains.

The global advance of such Chinese EV giants as BYD, which built more electric cars than Tesla in 2024, has concerned leaders in the United States and Europe, who worry that their automakers are under threat from Chinese rivals offering not just cheaper but potentially superior products.

SEE ELECTRIC VEHICLES ON A14

Green tech: China eclipses every other country in renewable energy. **A15**

Trump locks in sweeping tariffs on Mexico, Canada

MARKETS FALL WITH NEW RISK OF INFLATION

Both neighbors pledge retaliatory levies on U.S. goods

BY DAVID J. LYNCH, AMANDA COLETTA AND MARY BETH SHERIDAN

President Donald Trump said tariffs on goods from Mexico and Canada would go into effect Tuesday, ending a month-long delay that saw both U.S. neighbors scramble unsuccessfully to head off the punishing trade action and sending stock prices into a swift decline.

On Wall Street, the Dow Jones Industrial Average closed down around 1.5 percent Monday, as investors digested Trump's comments. The broader S&P 500 index fell nearly 2 percent. Both market measures are now in the red since Trump's election win.

Imposing tariffs on everything Americans buy from Mexico and Canada is an extraordinary polit-

ical gamble by a president who was returned to power by voters angered over years of high inflation. The new import taxes are likely to raise the market prices of Mexican tequila, beer and avocados, along with Canadian crude oil and lumber, testing consumer patience with Trump's approach.

Tariffs on China will also increase by an additional 10 percentage points for the second time in two months, bringing the total tax on some Chinese products to 45 percent.

Trump's announcement stemmed from his complaints

SEE TARIFFS ON A6

Chips deal: Trump, Taiwanese firm unveil \$100B investment in U.S. **A4**

Price hikes: These goods could get more expensive under the taxes. **A6**

Trump to pause future military aid for Ukraine

President seeks to force Zelensky into peace talks with Russia, officials say

BY JOHN HUDSON AND MICHAEL BIRNBAUM

President Donald Trump has decided to pause all future deliveries of U.S. military assistance to Ukraine in an extraordinary move aimed at pressuring Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky into peace talks with Russia, said two U.S. officials familiar with the matter.

U.S. military support for Ukraine has been essential to fending off Russia's invading

forces, but what started as a conflict with widespread bipartisan support has fractured along partisan lines amid doubts about the war's costs and a diplomatic off-ramp.

“The president has been clear that he is focused on peace. We need our partners to be committed to that goal as well,” said a White House official who, like others, spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive policy deliberations. “We are pausing and reviewing our aid to ensure that it is contributing to a solution.”

Trump has long been skeptical of aid to Ukraine, but his top

SEE UKRAINE ON A8

War-time garb: Ukrainians answer sartorial criticism of Zelensky. **A10**

Interim U.S. attorney vows D.C. crackdown

BY SPENCER S. HSU, KEITH L. ALEXANDER, PETER HERMANN AND JENNY GATHRIGHT

Interim U.S. attorney Ed Martin on Monday directed his office to prosecute more firearms cases in federal court, launching a bid to crack down on gun violence in Washington, D.C., that revived a strategy from President Donald Trump's first term.

The focus on charging gun cases in a court with harsher penalties targets felons in illegal possession of a firearm and re-

Martin echoes president on gun violence after demoting 7 prosecutors

peat violent offenders, according to an email Martin sent to staff. In announcing the push, Martin rolled out an initiative to “Make D.C. Safe Again.” The language echoes that of Trump, who has derided Washington as a “nightmare of murder and crime.”

“This is a whole of office initia-

tive to dramatically change course to fight violent crime. ... We will flood the federal district court with cases,” Martin wrote to staff in announcing the plan, which he said will be supported by about a dozen additional federal agents with the Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco, Firearms and Explosives.

Martin in public statements has pledged a focus on gun violence in D.C. as he vowed to reshape the office, recasting the prosecutions of Jan. 6, 2021, Capitol riot participants the office

SEE GUNS ON A7

A fight for purse strings as shutdown looms

BY JACOB BOGAGE

Congress has less than two weeks to extend federal spending laws and keep the government open, but now a clash over President Donald Trump's attempt to seize powers the Constitution delegates to lawmakers threatens to stall talks and force a shutdown.

Republican negotiators walked away from talks over the weekend to reach a deal on a top-line number on how much the federal government should spend for the rest of the 2025

Trump has tried to claim powers constitutionally delegated to lawmakers

fiscal year, which runs through Sept. 30. Democrats had said that number is irrelevant if Trump refuses to spend the money in accordance with the law — or if he empowers billionaire Elon Musk and his U.S. DOGE Service to terminate federal contracts and lay off tens of thousands of feder-

al workers without regard to Congress's wishes.

Trump and advisers including budget chief Russell Vought have argued that the president has the power to withhold money that Congress orders spent, arguing that a post-Watergate law that limits that power is unconstitutional. Musk's DOGE team has been unilaterally terminating contracts and pushing to shed federal workers.

SEE SHUTDOWN ON A9

D.C. budget: Three-year revenue forecast takes a billion-dollar hit. **B1**

IN THE NEWS

Nats, O's end MASN deal The dissolution of the agreement after 20 years lets Washington sell its TV rights on the open market. In an era of cord-cutting, that may not be easy. **D1**

A last picture show D.C.'s E Street Cinema, a premier showcase for independent films that struggled in the pandemic, closed Sunday. **B1**

THE NATION **U.S. gunmakers** are asking the Supreme Court to stop a lawsuit from Mexico over violence in that nation. **A3** **A man** pleaded guilty in a mass killing in Illinois on July 4, 2022. **A7**

THE WORLD **Pope Francis** was put back on a ventilator after two episodes of acute respiratory failure. **A11** **Arab leaders** were racing to finalize a proposal for Gaza's future ahead of a summit Tuesday. **A12**

THE ECONOMY **Even if** the war ends and sanctions are lifted, U.S. companies are skeptical about the economic prospects in Russia. **A13** **With NASA's** lunar program faltering, private companies are launching a flurry of uncrewed missions to the moon. **A16**

THE REGION **A Maryland** ballet program for disabled youths may be in jeopardy after changes to a grant program under the Trump administration. **B1** **Virginia Gov.** Glenn Youngkin commuted the sentence of a former officer who fatally shot an unarmed man. **B1**

STYLE **At Vanity Fair's** splashy post-Oscars party, stars gathered to gawk at other stars and their trophies. **C1** **HEALTH & SCIENCE** **At age 67,** this writer is still learning to fight his own negative stereotypes about getting older. **E1**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A13
COMICS.....C7
OBITUARIES.....B4
OPINION PAGES.....A17
TELEVISION.....C6
WORLD NEWS.....A10

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54145

0 170628 21100 3